

MIZORAM PUBLIC SERVICE COMMISSION
COMPETITIVE EXAMINATION FOR RECRUITMENT TO THE POST OF
CIRCLE EDUCATION OFFICER UNDER SCHOOL EDUCATION
DEPARTMENT, GOVERNMENT OF MIZORAM.
(NOVEMBER, 2025)

GENERAL ENGLISH

Time Allowed : 3 hours

FM : 100

PART-A
(34 Marks)

*This Section should be answered only on the Answer Sheet provided.
Marks for each question is indicated against it. Attempt all questions.*

1. Write a précis of the following passage and provide an appropriate title. **(14)**
Reading or the enjoyment of books has always been regarded among the charms of cultured life and is respected and envied by those who rarely give themselves that privilege. This is easy to understand when we compare the differences between the life of a man who does no reading and that of a man who does. The man who has not the habit of reading is imprisoned in his immediate world, in respect of time and place. His life falls into a set routine; he is limited to contact and conversation with a few friends and acquaintances, and he sees only what happens in his immediate neighbourhood. From this prison there is no escape. But the moment he takes up a book, he immediately enters a different world, and if it is a good book, he is immediately put in touch with one of the best talkers of the world. This talker leads him on and carries him into a different country or a different age, or unburdens to him some of his personal regrets, or discusses with him some special line or aspect of life that the reader knows nothing about. An ancient author puts him in communion with a dead spirit of long ago, and as he reads along, he begins to imagine what that ancient author looked like and what type of person he was. Now to be able to live two hours out of twelve in a different world and take one's thought off the claims of the immediate present is, of course, a privilege to be envied by people shut in their bodily prison. But there is more to it than this. The reader is always carried away into a world of thought and reflection. Even if it is a book about physical events, there is a difference between seeing such events in person or living through them, and reading about them in books, for then the events always assume the quality of a spectacle and the reader becomes a detached spectator. The best reading is therefore that which leads us into this contemplative mood, and not that which is merely occupied with the report of events.
2. Write a formal application as XYZ for the post of Lecturer in Social Science addressed to the Principal, MYG Higher Secondary School, Bawngkawn, Aizawl, Mizoram in response to the advertisement in The Aizawl Post, Vol. XVII, Issue 21 of 12th August 2025. **(10)**

3. Read the following passage and answer the questions given at the end:

Toward the end of her day in London Mrs. Drover went round to her shut-up house to look for several things she wanted to take away. Some belonged to herself, some to her family, who were by now used to their country life. It was late August; it had been a steamy, showery day. At the moment the trees down the pavement glittered in an escape of humid yellow afternoon sun. Against the next batch of clouds already piling up ink-dark, broken chimneys and parapets stood out. In her once familiar street, as in any unused channel, an unfamiliar queerness had silted up; a cat wove itself in and out of railings, but no human eye watched Mrs. Drover's return. Shifting some parcels under her arm, she slowly forced round her latchkey in an unwilling lock, then gave the door, which had warped, a push with her knee. Dead air came out to meet her as she went in.

The staircase window having been boarded up, no light came down into the hall.

But one door, she could just see, stood ajar, so she went quickly through into the room and unshuttered the big window in there. Now the prosaic woman, looking about her, was more perplexed than she knew by everything that she saw, by traces of her long former habit of life—the yellow smoke stain up the white marble mantelpiece, the ring left by a vase on the top of the escritoire; the bruise in the wallpaper where, on the door being thrown open widely, the china handle had always hit the wall. The piano, having gone away to be stored, had left what looked like claw marks on its part of the parquet. Though not much dust had seeped in, each object wore a film of another kind; and, the only ventilation being the chimney, the whole drawing room smelled of the cold hearth. Mrs. Drover put down her parcels on the escritoire and left the room to proceed upstairs; the things she wanted were in a bedroom chest.

She had been anxious to see how the house was—the part-time caretaker she shared with some neighbours was away this week on his holiday, known to be not yet back. At the best of times he did not look in often, and she was never sure that she trusted him. There were some cracks in the structure, left by the last bombing, on which she was anxious to keep an eye. Not that one could do anything. A shaft of refracted daylight now lay across the hall. She stopped dead and stared at the hall table—on this lay a letter addressed to her.

- (i) Why was Mrs. Drover anxious to see how the house was? (2)
- (ii) Why did Mrs. Drover go to her "shut-up house"? (2)
- (iii) Describe how Mrs. Drover enters the house. (2)
- (iv) What are the things Mrs. Drover notices when she enters the house? (2)
- (v) Find words in the passage that has the same meaning as the following: (2×1=2)
 - (a) trickled or flowed
 - (b) gazed or looked

PART-B
(66 Marks)

*All questions carry equal mark of 1 each. Attempt all questions.
This Section should be answered only on the OMR Response Sheet provided.*

Direction (Question Nos. 1 - 5) : Identify the parts of speech of the underlined words:

1. She expressed her happiness on receiving a scholarship.
(a) Noun (b) Adjective
(c) Verb (d) Preposition
2. You must obey your parents.
(a) Adjective (b) Verb
(c) Adverb (d) Noun
3. The harvest is almost ripe.
(a) Adverb (b) Preposition
(c) Adjective (d) Conjunction
4. The father divided the inheritance among his daughters and sons.
(a) Conjunction (b) Interjection
(c) Adjective (d) Preposition
5. You must have some food, for you are hungry and have a long journey ahead.
(a) Conjunction (b) Adverb
(c) Preposition (d) Adjective

Direction (Question Nos. 6 - 15) : Fill in the blanks with the appropriate preposition/ conjunction:

6. Mrs. Sharma saw the gardener sitting _____ her grandson.
(a) along (b) besides
(c) beside (d) in
7. The heir to the throne was born _____ March last year.
(a) at (b) in
(c) by (d) on
8. The manager told his staff that he would return _____ a month.
(a) for (b) on
(c) within (d) with
9. I have met with a lot of hurdles _____ we last spoke on the phone.
(a) while (b) while
(c) before (d) since
10. He tried his best _____ could not land the job.
(a) within (b) in
(c) but (d) on
11. Hurry up _____ you will miss the train.
(a) only (b) or
(c) but (d) while

12. I prefer coffee _____ tea.
(a) before (b) over
(c) from (d) to
13. We are very excited _____ our trip to New Delhi next week.
(a) at (b) about
(c) with (d) from
14. She insisted _____ helping me with the dishes.
(a) on (b) for
(c) in (d) against
15. The driver is recovering _____ his injuries.
(a) with (b) without
(c) after (d) from

Direction (Question Nos. 16 - 25) : Fill in the blanks with the appropriate form of the verbs from the given choices:

16. The pillar _____ when he climbed it this morning.
(a) has shaken (b) shakes
(c) is shaking (d) was shaking
17. Mr. Miyagi _____ on this project since 2022.
(a) will work (b) will be working
(c) has been working (d) had worked
18. The sun _____ in the east.
(a) rises (b) does rise
(c) rise (d) rose
19. The boy _____ he had asked another question to the doctor.
(a) wish (b) wished
(c) will have been wishing (d) has wished
20. Who _____ my laptop?
(a) steal (b) has stolen
(c) stole (d) stealed
21. Hruaii _____ in the marathon tomorrow at 5:00 a.m.
(a) will be running (b) will have run
(c) runs (d) would run
22. Martha _____ to be a doctor when she grows up.
(a) wants (b) is wanting
(c) want (d) have wanted
23. He rushed home after he _____ the phone call.
(a) was receiving (b) receive
(c) received (d) receives

24. While the doctor _____ the patient, there was an uproar in the hall.
(a) is examining (b) has examined
(c) was examining (d) examines
25. The passengers deboarded after the plane _____.
(a) is landing (b) will land
(c) has been landing (d) landed

Direction (Question Nos. 26 - 29) : Complete the following sentences with the most appropriate words:

26. Mrs. Clooney is an _____ lawyer.
(a) imminent (b) integral
(c) eminent (d) intelligible
27. When you write your thesis, make sure to _____ the sources you have used.
(a) sight (b) sight
(c) cite (d) sigh
28. My brother is a _____ who works for money and not for honour.
(a) military (b) moralist
(c) fatalist (d) mercenary
29. He is a _____ who cannot stay loyal to one woman.
(a) philanthropist (b) misanthropist
(c) philanderer (d) pedestrian

Direction (Question Nos. 30 - 33) : Substitute each expression with a single word from among the given alternatives:

30. The custom of having many wives-
(a) misogamy (b) bigamy
(c) polygamy (d) monogamy
31. A person who studies stars, planets and other heavenly bodies-
(a) astrology (b) astrophysics
(c) astronomer (d) astroentitis
32. A science of the structure of human body-
(a) palaeontology (b) atomy
(c) epistemology (d) anatomy
33. One who looks at the dark side of things-
(a) pessimist (b) optimist
(c) philanthropist (d) anarchist

Direction (Question Nos. 34 - 37) : Choose the most appropriate meaning for the following idioms and phrases.

34. To bury the hatchet
(a) To be violent and cruel (b) To be very handy
(c) To make peace (d) To make use of an opportunity
35. A fair weather friend
(a) A selfish friend (b) A lazy friend
(c) A selfless friend (d) A complete friend
36. To throw dust in one's eyes
(a) To give an advantage (b) To inspire
(c) To encourage (d) To discourage
37. A wild goose chase
(a) A significant chase (b) A well-planned pursuit
(c) An impromptu treasure hunt (d) A foolish and useless pursuit

Direction (Question Nos. 38 - 41) : Choose a word that is opposite in meaning to the given word from among the given alternatives:

38. admire
(a) detest (b) envy
(c) adore (d) praise
39. contrary
(a) inclusive (b) prominent
(c) repudiate (d) similar
40. repulsive
(a) meek (b) alluring
(c) hideous (d) exhibiting
41. demolish
(a) destroy (b) collapse
(c) praise (d) construct

Direction (Question Nos. 42 - 46) : Choose the correct option as directed in the bracket:

42. The fire was burning in the forest. (*Change to Future Perfect Continuous Tense*)
(a) The fire had been burning in the forest
(b) The fire will have been burning in the forest
(c) The fire will be burning in the forest
(d) The fire will had been burning in the forest
43. The man spread false rumours about his wife (*Change to Past Continuous Tense*)
(a) The man was spreading false rumours about his wife
(b) The man is spreading false rumours about his wife
(c) The man had been spreading false rumours about his wife
(d) The man had spread false rumours about his wife

- 44.. Mrs. Solis refused to help her husband. (*Change to Present Indefinite Tense*)
- (a) Mrs. Solis has refused to help her husband
 - (b) Mrs. Solis was refusing to help her husband
 - (c) Mrs. Solis refuses to help her husband
 - (d) Mrs. Solis is refusing to help her husband
45. The farmer has reaped his harvest. (*Change to Past Perfect Tense*)
- (a) The farmer was reaping his harvest
 - (b) The farmer reaped his harvest
 - (c) The farmer had reaped his harvest
 - (d) The farmer is reaping his harvest
46. Who is knocking at the door? (*Change to Future Indefinite Tense*)
- (a) Who will be knocking on the door?
 - (b) Who will knock on the door?
 - (c) Who will have been knocking on the door?
 - (d) Who will have knocked on the door?

Direction (Question Nos. 47 - 51) : Select the appropriate direct/indirect speech from the options given:

- 47 The teacher said, "It has been raining since this morning"
- (a) The teacher says that it has been raining since that morning
 - (b) The teacher said that it had been raining since that morning
 - (c) The teacher said that it has been raining since this morning
 - (d) The teacher said that it was raining since that morning
48. Sarah said, "The soldiers were marching towards the castle"
- (a) Sarah said that the soldiers were marching towards the castle
 - (b) Sarah said that the soldiers had marched towards the castle
 - (c) Sarah said that the soldiers have been marching towards the castle
 - (d) Sarah said that the soldiers had been marching towards the castle
49. Benjamin said that he did not enjoy the concert.
- (a) Benjamin said, "I have not enjoyed the concert"
 - (b) Benjamin said, "I am not enjoying the concert"
 - (c) Benjamin said, "I did not enjoy the concert"
 - (d) Benjamin said, "I had not enjoyed the concert"
50. Siama said to Kimi, "Why are you sketching on the wall?"
- (a) Siama asked Kimi why was she sketching on the wall.
 - (b) Siama asked Kimi why had she been sketching on the wall.
 - (c) Siama asked Kimi why she is sketching on the wall.
 - (d) Siama asked Kimi why she was sketching on the wall.
51. He said, "I saw a rabbit here."
- (a) He said that he had been seeing a rabbit there.
 - (b) He said that he had seen a rabbit there.
 - (c) He said that he has seen a rabbit here.
 - (d) He said that he has been seeing a rabbit here.

Direction (Question Nos. 52 - 56) : Choose the correct word to connect the following sentences:

52. She is the girl _____ I shall marry.
(a) who (b) whom
(c) whose (d) once
53. I wore only a shirt _____ it was very cold.
(a) however (b) unless
(c) provided (d) although
54. I will do it _____ you want me to do it.
(a) however (b) whither
(c) since (d) that
55. It is not certain _____ he will leave or stay.
(a) that (b) whether
(c) because (d) which
56. The patient died _____ receiving the best medical care available.
(a) because (b) as far as
(c) despite (d) however

Direction (Question Nos. 57 - 61) : Choose a word that is similar in meaning to the given word from among the given alternatives-

57. eloquence
(a) elegance (b) despair
(c) fluency (d) obstinate
58. feeble
(a) weak (b) cruel
(c) violent (d) delightful
59. incongruous
(a) careless (b) indifferent
(c) undisguised (d) inappropriate
60. nonchalant
(a) ambiguous (b) reserved
(c) indifferent (d) patient
61. despise
(a) love (b) hate
(c) admire (d) respect

Direction (Question Nos. 62 -66) : Choose the correct transformation for the following sentences as directed against each:

62. Everybody is present.

(transform this into a negative sentence)

(a) Everybody is absent.

(b) Everybody is not present.

(c) Nobody is present.

(d) Nobody is absent.

63. No one can deny that she sings well.

(transform this into assertive sentence)

(a) Everybody accepts that she sings well.

(b) Nobody can accept that she sings well.

(c) Can anyone deny that she sings well?

(d) Nobody can deny that she sings well.

64. It was a lovely day.

(transform it into exclamatory sentence)

(a) Is it not a lovely day!

(b) What a lovely day it was!

(c) Ah! Today is a lovely day.

(d) What a lovely day today!

65 It is useless to cry over spilt milk.

(transform it into interrogative sentence)

(a) Is it useful to not cry over spilt milk?

(b) Is it not useless to cry over spilt milk?

(c) Is it useless to cry over spilt milk?

(d) Is it useless to not cry over spilt milk?

66. Isn't the building red in colour?

(transform this into a negative sentence)

(a) Is the building red in colour?

(b) The building is red in colour.

(c) Is the building not red in colour?

(d) The building is not red in colour.

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